

INTERNAL COORDINATION DOCUMENT

Narrative Framing Guide

For Use By: US State Department, Iranian Foreign Ministry,
Joint Secretariat, Guarantor States

Not for Public Distribution

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Core Principle

The same text allows both sides to claim victory.

No statement constitutes a lie. Each statement constitutes a choice of emphasis. Every claim traces to a specific article or annex.

When the other side says something that sounds opposite, the spokesperson checks the citation. Both sides probably look at different paragraphs.

How to Use This Guide

- Each issue area provides a US Frame, an Iranian Frame, and the specific citation that supports both
- The frames do not contradict one another — they emphasize different operative clauses of the same text
- Spokespersons memorize their frames and the corresponding citations
- Mediators use the neutral frame when speaking on behalf of the process
- Each side's prohibited phrases appear below — both sides avoid them; they trigger the other side's hawks

Verification Discipline

Before any public statement, the spokesperson or press officer confirms that the claim appears in the operative text of the Accord or its annexes. If the claim does not appear in the text, the spokesperson does not say it. If the claim appears in a different section than the one cited, the spokesperson cites the correct section. **Misattribution is as dangerous as fabrication.**

Guide Enforcement: This guide is voluntary, not binding. However, any spokesperson who repeatedly uses prohibited phrases or violates red-line frames receives notation as such in the Joint Secretariat's internal coordination log. Persistent violations trigger a review of whether that Party acts in good faith under Annex T, Article IV.3 (Narrative Dispute Resolution).

The Synchronisation Sentence — Iranian Public Framing of Enhanced Measures

The following sentences are suggested templates only. Iran adapts, combines, or replaces them with its own formulation. The purpose is not to prescribe Iran's words — it is to demonstrate that a sovereignty-safe public sentence exists.

Each sentence allows the United States to state that "Iran accepted tougher verification," while Iran maintains that its dignity, sovereignty, and rights remain intact.

Suggested Sentence #1 — Technical Emphasis

"We have agreed to a technical implementation mechanism that ensures full compliance with international standards while preserving our sovereign rights. The enhanced measures are operational, not political."

Why it works: No mention of "concession" or "surrender." The sentence frames acceptance as a technical matter, not a political defeat. It preserves Iranian sovereignty explicitly. It gives the US a hook: "Iran agreed to enhanced verification."

Suggested Sentence #2 — Reciprocity Emphasis

"As the United States fulfills its commitments, Iran implements the agreed verification protocols. This is a reciprocal arrangement, not a unilateral concession. Nothing enters the pipeline before verification."

Why it works: This sentence directly mirrors the Reciprocity Frame. Iran frames its compliance as response, not submission. It implicitly demands US performance. It uses the guide's own language ("nothing enters the pipeline before verification").

Suggested Sentence #3 — Strategic Choice Framing (Dignity Emphasis)

"Iran has chosen a path of transparency and cooperation. The measures we implement are our own sovereign decisions, not impositions by any foreign power. Our rights are preserved. Our future is in our own hands."

Why it works: This sentence frames cooperation as Iran's choice, not US pressure. It uses the Iranian Anchor Line ("Our future is in our own hands"). It projects strength through

zero defensive language. It remains factually compatible with the US victory narrative.

Suggested Sentence #4 — Sovereignty Automation Emphasis

"Within the framework of our immutable sovereign rights, we have agreed to activate a non-discretionary, automated technical matrix that systematically verifies the completion of our domestic remediation and instantly normalizes all restricted asset tracks."

Why it works: This sentence frames verification as an automated technical matrix — not a political concession. It preserves sovereign rights explicitly through the "immutable sovereign rights" framing. It normalizes asset tracks instantly upon verification completion — not upon US approval. It projects technical sophistication and self-determination simultaneously.

Guidance for Spokespersons

If a reporter asks "What exactly did Iran agree to?", the Iranian spokesperson uses any of the above sentences, or a close derivative, without deviating from the Core Principle.

If a reporter asks "Did Iran accept Trump's tougher terms?", the US spokesperson points to the same sentences and says: *"Iran has agreed to a technical implementation framework with enhanced verification. Their own statements confirm it."*

Both statements are factually accurate. Neither contradicts the other.

What This Section Does Not Contain

This section does not contain the exact sentence Iran uses. Iran speaks in its own voice, for its own audience. These suggestions only demonstrate that such a sentence exists — and that the architecture supports it.

Sentence Selection Guide

Table NF-2A Synchronisation Sentence Selection

Sentence	Best For
#1 (Technical)	Early announcements, technical audiences
#2 (Reciprocity)	Domestic Iranian reformist media, Western outlets
#3 (Strategic Choice)	Hardliner audiences, sovereignty-focused framing

#4 (Sovereignty Automation) Technical sovereignty framing, domestic hardliner audiences

The Three Permanent Frames

Every public statement by either side falls into one of these three buckets. These frames constitute the structural pillars of all narrative coordination:

Table NF-1 The Three Permanent Frames

Frame	US Emphasis	Iranian Emphasis	Citation Anchor
Verification	"We see everything. The IAEA holds physical custody. Our sensors stand active."	"We retain sovereignty. Legal title stays with Iran. Foreign inspectors remain guests, not occupiers."	Art 1.1 (custody); Art 1.3 (title); Annex O (site access protocols)
Reciprocity	"Iran receives nothing before performance. The framework releases benefits only after verified performance."	"The US lifts pressure step by step. Nothing enters the pipeline before verification. We keep our leverage."	Annex S (sequencing); Art 8.2 (escrow); Annex T (stepback/earnback)
Duration	"No sunset exists. The deal continues as long as Iran complies. Non-compliance pauses benefits."	"No permanent surrender exists. Either side withdraws with notice. Phase II constitutes a new negotiation."	Art 17.2–17.4 (rolling horizon); Art 17.4 (no clawback); Annex T, Art IX

Frame Discipline

Every public statement carries the DNA of at least one of these three frames. If a statement does not map to Verification, Reciprocity, or Duration, the spokesperson reconsiders it. Statements that fall outside these frames create narrative noise and confuse domestic audiences.

Frame Compatibility

These frames are not mutually exclusive. A single statement carries all three: *"Because Iran permits IAEA verification at all declared sites, the United States releases the first tranche of escrowed assets. This does not constitute a gift — it constitutes earned performance. It*

continues as long as verification continues." This statement carries Verification (IAEA access), Reciprocity (tranche released), and Duration (continues).

Issue 1: HEU Custody (Article 1 + Annex O, P)

Table NF-2 HEU Custody — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Physical custody	"Weapons-grade uranium sits under IAEA lock and key within 14 days. US-accessible monitoring confirms the arrangement." (Art 1.1; Annex O)	"The material remains Iranian property on Iranian soil by default. The IAEA enters as a guest for verification purposes." (Art 1.1; Art 1.3)
Legal title	"The framework secures the material — that constitutes what matters." (Art 1.1 legal title clause)	"The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign title. No foreign power holds title to our nuclear material." (Art 1.1)
Damaged cylinders	"Even damaged material undergoes neutralization through in-situ downblending. No actor hides behind the 'inaccessible' label." (Annex P, Art 3)	"We protect our people and environment. Damaged cylinders undergo downblending in place — not through risky extraction." (Annex P, Art 3)
Final disposition	"The framework defers final disposition to negotiation, but the US retains veto power over Russian and hybrid pathways." (Art 1.5)	"We choose the pathway freely from six options. The US exercises veto power over only two pathways — Russia and hybrid require mutual agreement." (Art 1.5)
Nuclear Dust extraction	"We are physically extracting and containerizing 99.7% of Iran's highly enriched uranium. IAEA-certified. Irreversible." (Annex V)	"We are cooperating in a technical remediation effort. Iranian soil remains sovereign. The IAEA verifies, not controls." (Annex V)
Dual-key extraction	"No excavation happens without IAEA approval. We have a technical lock on their nuclear dust." (Annex V)	"Iran holds one of two digital keys. No extraction occurs without our authorization. Sovereignty is preserved." (Annex V)
Entombment fallback	"If extraction becomes impossible, permanent IAEA monitoring and seals lock the material in place forever." (Annex V, Art 5)	"If extraction is unsafe, we switch to monitored in-place containment. The material stays under IAEA eyes, not US control." (Annex V, Art 5)

Issue 2: Enrichment (Article 2)

Table NF-3 Enrichment — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Moratorium duration	"The moratorium spans 12 years minimum, extending to 15 with verified compliance. No breakout timeline exists." (Art 2.1)	"The moratorium operates on a 12-year baseline. Compliance extends it; good behavior earns longer trust." (Art 2.1)
Civilian enrichment	"Civilian enrichment limits itself to 3.67% at Natanz only. All other sites sit mothballed or converted." (Art 2.1; Art 3.2)	"Peaceful enrichment continues under IAEA safeguards. The Accord affirms our NPT rights." (Art 2.1; Art 3.2)

Issue 3: Maritime & PGSA (Article 4 + Annex N, N.a)

Table NF-4 Maritime & PGSA — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
JHTA role	"Advisory multilateral governance governs the maritime architecture. The US holds a permanent seat. No unilateral Iranian control exists." (Art 4.2-A; Art 4.2-B)	"The JHTA maintains advisory status only. The PGSA remains the sole executive coastal law enforcement body in our territorial waters. JHTA recommendations carry no binding force." (Art 4.2-B)
Transit fees	"No tolls exist. The MMMF operates as transparent, multilateral, and voluntary — vessels do not pay Iran directly." (Art 5.1)	"Iran receives 40% of fund revenue for civilian reconstruction. The Accord recognizes our coastal authority." (Art 5.1)
Interdiction	"The framework imposes absolute prohibition on interdiction. Any stopped ship triggers automatic penalties — \$1M per day, US escort authority." (Annex N, Art 2; Annex N.a, Art 2–3)	"We do not stop commercial vessels. The Accord preserves legitimate SOLAS safety inspections. The framework excludes force from fee collection mechanisms." (Annex N, Art 2; Annex N.a, Art 4)

Issue 4: Sanctions Relief & Escrow (Article 7 + Annex S)

Table NF-5 Sanctions Relief & Escrow — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Sequencing	"Every dollar of relief pairs with a verified nuclear milestone. No front-loading exists." (Annex S, Week 1–8)	"The US releases assets step by step as we meet benchmarks. The framework gives nothing away." (Annex S, Week 1–8)
Escrow protection	"The framework shields funds from diversion. Performance reserves ensure compliance." (Art 8.2)	"Neutral escrow holds our assets under sovereign immunity. The US lacks seizure authority." (Art 8.2)
Humanitarian firewall	"Medicine and food continue regardless of compliance disputes. The framework excludes civilian punishment from compliance disputes." (Annex T, Art II.4)	"The framework protects humanitarian channels permanently. The framework bars the use of starvation as a weapon." (Annex T, Art II.4)
Russian guarantor role	"Russia watches the escrow. No money moves without IAEA verification." (Annex V, Table V-1)	"Russia is an observer of the escrow, not a US ally in this process. Balance is preserved." (Annex V, Table V-1)
Tier 3 interest freeze	"If a Tier 3 breach occurs, no interest accrues to either side on held funds during the remediation period." (Annex V, Art 3.5)	"During Tier 3 remediation, the framework freezes interest accrual. No party profits from the other's breach." (Annex V, Art 3.5)

No-Interest During Tier 3 Remediation

If a Tier 3 breach occurs, no interest accrues to either side on held funds during the remediation period. This provision prevents perverse incentives — neither side profits from the other's non-compliance. The framework incentivizes rapid remediation, not prolonged dispute.

Issue 5: Escalation Buffer (Annex R + R.a)

Table NF-6 Escalation Buffer — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Kinetic incidents	"A single rogue drone does not collapse the deal. The buffer gives us time to assess before responding." (Annex R, Art 4; Annex R.a, Art 1)	"The buffer prevents the US from using minor incidents as a pretext for war. The framework preserves our right to self-defense." (Annex R, Art 4; Annex R.a, Art 1.3)
Back-channel	"Pakistan, Switzerland, Oman — 24/7. We talk before we shoot." (Annex R.a, Art 2–3)	"Neutral facilitators ensure both sides receive hearing. No one faces silence." (Annex R.a, Art 2–3)
Rogue actor	"If Iran disavows within 24 hours, we do not attribute the event to the state. Transparency earns reward." (Annex R.a, Art 4)	"Third-party false-flag attacks do not attach to Iran. The framework does not hold us responsible for what we did not order." (Annex R.a, Art 4)

Issue 6: IRGC Access (Annex Q)

Table NF-7 IRGC Access — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
NAC role	"Iran appoints a single official responsible for IRGC compliance. No more 'we lack control' excuses exist." (Annex Q, Art 3)	"We maintain a National Access Coordinator with authority over all sites. The IRGC answers to the state." (Annex Q, Art 3)
Attribution	"IRGC denial equals Iranian denial. No distinction exists." (Annex Q, Art 4)	"The IRGC constitutes an arm of the state. We accept responsibility for their compliance." (Annex Q, Art 4)

Issue 7: Lebanon / Levant (Appendix E + v4.0 changes)

Table NF-8 Lebanon / Levant — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Firewall	"Lebanon incidents do not trigger the core deal. The threshold now reaches 10 casualties + JIG majority vote." (Appendix E.2.2)	"The firewall protects the core agreement from Israeli military action in Lebanon." (Appendix E.2.2)
Regional Basket	"A separate track handles Israel-Lebanon de-escalation. Full Israeli participation operates within that track." (Appendix E.3)	"Iran ensures our allies in Lebanon do not face abandonment. The Basket ends the war on all fronts." (Appendix E.3)

Issue 8: Military Escalation (Article 18)

Table NF-9 Military Escalation — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
No automatic escalation	"A compliance dispute over enrichment levels does not justify bombing. We control our military decisions." (Art 18.1–18.2)	"The framework excludes military strikes for minor compliance pretexts. Breach triggers economic step-back, not war." (Art 18.1–18.2)

Issue 9: Duration & Withdrawal (Article 17 + Annex T)

Table NF-10 Duration & Withdrawal — Issue-by-Issue Framing Matrix

Element	US Frame	Iranian Frame
Rolling horizon	"No sunset exists. The deal continues as long as Iran complies. Non-compliance pauses benefits." (Art 17.2–17.4)	"No permanent surrender exists. Either side withdraws with notice. Phase II constitutes a new negotiation, not an extension of Phase I." (Art 17.2–17.4)
No clawback	"Funds already released before a withdrawal notice are not clawed back. A clean break, not a trap." (Annex V, Art 4.5)	"Our assets, once released, belong to us. No clawback mechanism exists. A clean exit path." (Annex V, Art 4.5)
Review Pause	"If an election, leadership transition, or crisis occurs, the deal enters a Review Pause — not termination. Humanitarian and core security modules continue." (Annex V, Art 4.6)	"If political change occurs, the deal enters a Review Pause — not termination. Our humanitarian protections and security buffers remain active." (Annex V, Art 4.6)

Political Shock Absorber

The Review Pause provision (Annex V, Art 4.6) is how the deal survives real-world chaos. It is not a loophole — it is a structural feature. Elections, leadership transitions, and external crises do not terminate the Accord. They activate a pause during which humanitarian and core security modules continue operating. Neither side exploits the pause for advantage.

Talking Points for Key Moments

The following talking points are pre-approved for use at each milestone event. Each pair is designed for simultaneous delivery or delivery in close temporal proximity. Neither contradicts the other.

At Signature (Simultaneous Announcement)

Table NF-11 Signature Event Talking Points

US Talking Point	Iranian Talking Point
"Weapons-grade uranium secures itself under IAEA custody within 14 days."	"Legal title remains with Iran. The framework defers final disposition to negotiation."
"Every relief measure earns itself through verified milestones."	"The US lifts pressure step by step. Nothing enters the pipeline before verification."
"No sunset exists. Compliance keeps the deal alive."	"No permanent surrender exists. Withdrawal remains permitted with notice."

At First IAEA Access (Day 1–7)

Table NF-12 First IAEA Access Talking Points

US Talking Point	Iranian Talking Point
"Inspectors enter the facilities. We see everything."	"Inspectors enter as guests. The framework respects our sovereignty."
"Continuous monitoring equipment installs itself at Natanz and Fordow."	"IAEA monitoring operates under our supervision, on our terms, at our facilities."

At First Interdiction (if it happens)

Table NF-13 First Interdiction Event Talking Points

US Talking Point	Iranian Talking Point
"Automatic penalty: \$1M per day, US escort authority. This does not stand."	"We investigate the report. The Annex permits legitimate SOLAS safety actions."

"The back-channel activates. We communicate with Iran through Pakistan and Oman."

"We communicate through neutral facilitators. The facts establish themselves."

At a Kinetic Incident (drone, missile intercept)

Table NF-14 Kinetic Incident Talking Points

US Talking Point	Iranian Talking Point
"The 72-hour buffer activates. We assess through the Pakistan back-channel. No rush to judgment exists."	"The buffer prevents the US from using this as a pretext. We communicate through neutral facilitators."
"Full sensor coverage operates. The verification architecture tells us what happened."	"We call for a joint investigation. The facts establish themselves before any accusation flies."

At Phase II Transition (Day 60–90)

Table NF-15 Phase II Transition Talking Points

US Talking Point	Iranian Talking Point
"Phase I verification completes itself. Deeper limits on enrichment and missiles now sit on the table. Nothing enters Phase II unless we agree."	"Phase II constitutes a new negotiation. Our NPT rights remain. No automatic rollover of Phase I terms exists. Our rights are not surrendered."
"Iran earns the benefits released. The escrow architecture works."	"We meet every benchmark. The US releases our assets as agreed. Reciprocity demonstrates itself."

What to Say When Asked About Annex M

Given the urgency of the 70% directive and the territorial freeze, reporters ask about Gaza and Lebanon. The following pre-approved responses are calibrated for each side.

For US Spokespersons

"Annex M freezes the current territorial footprint. Israel holds its position. Israel advances no further. The Shared Digital Registry gives everyone real-time visibility. If a violation occurs, the penalties activate automatically — \$1M per day, reconstruction freeze, supply suspension. The framework removes debate from the equation. The sensors decide."

For Iranian Spokespersons

"Annex M locks in Israeli expansion at 60% — not the 70% they announced. Automatic penalties activate if they advance further. The Shared Digital Registry gives us real-time visibility. This represents the best achievable outcome without collapsing the entire deal. Our strategic patience works."

Citation Reference

Annex M (Territorial Baseline and Ceasefire Demarcation Protocol) establishes the Shared Digital Registry for real-time territorial monitoring. Art 3.1 (automatic penalty accrual); Art 4 (reconstruction freeze trigger); Art 5 (supply suspension mechanism). The 60% / 70% figures refer to the territorial control percentage frozen at the baseline date.

Prohibited Phrases (Both Sides)

These phrases trigger the other side's hawks. Both sides avoid them in all official statements. The Accord does not prohibit them; political common sense prohibits them.

Table NF-16 Prohibited Phrases

US Does NOT Say	Iran Does NOT Say
"Iran surrendered"	"America capitulated"
"Permanent disarmament"	"Permanent surrender"
"Iran admitted guilt"	"US admitted defeat"
"We verified the IRGC is gone"	"The US withdrew from the Gulf"
"Snapback" (use "stepback" instead)	"Resistance" (in context of violating terms)
"Iran blinked"	"The US was forced to negotiate"
"Maximum pressure worked"	"We defeated the sanctions regime"
"The ayatollahs agreed"	"The Great Satan yielded"

Why These Are Dangerous

Each prohibited phrase contains an evaluative claim — win/loss, victory/defeat, dominance/submission — that forces the other side to respond in kind. The Accord allows both sides to claim success without the other side conceding failure. These phrases break that architecture.

Replacement Rule

If a prohibited phrase appears in a draft statement, the spokesperson replaces it with a descriptive claim tied to a specific article. *"Iran surrendered its HEU"* becomes *"Iran's HEU stockpile sits under IAEA physical custody per Article 1.1."* Same fact. No surrender implied.

Non-Negotiable Narrative Red Lines

These statements are **never true**, regardless of the questioner's framing. If asked to confirm or deny any of these, the spokesperson rejects the premise and restates the correct frame.

Table NF-16A Non-Negotiable Narrative Red Lines

US Red Line — Never Agree	Iranian Red Line — Never Agree
"Iran holds the right to enrich uranium to weapons-grade levels"	"The US holds veto power over Iran's nuclear program"
"The IAEA maintains permanent stationing inside Iranian military facilities"	"Iran surrenders its nuclear material"
"The US pays reparations to Iran"	"The US snaps back all sanctions at any time without cause"
"Iran disarms itself permanently of conventional missiles"	"Iran agrees to unlimited inspections in perpetuity"
"The US controls Iran's banking system"	"The deal gives the US a permanent military presence in the Gulf"
"Israel holds veto power over the Accord"	"Iran recognizes Israel's right to exist as part of the deal"

Trap Question Protocol

EXAMPLE TRAP QUESTION

Question: "Did Iran surrender its nuclear program?"

Correct response (Iranian spokesperson):

"That is incorrect. The Central Bank of Iran retains full legal title to all enriched uranium. Physical custody to the IAEA constitutes a verification step for Phase I, not surrender. Final disposition defers to negotiation, and the US holds no veto over our chosen pathway."

(Art 1.1; Art 1.3; Art 1.5)

Correct Response (US Spokesperson — Parallel Example)

EXAMPLE TRAP QUESTION

Question: "Does the US control Iran's nuclear program now?"

Correct response (US spokesperson):

"That is incorrect. The IAEA holds physical custody for verification purposes only. Iran retains sovereign legal title through the Central Bank of Iran. The US exercises no operational control over Iranian facilities and no veto over four of the six final disposition pathways."

(Art 1.1; Art 1.3; Art 1.5)

Response Frames for Provocative Statements

When the other side says something that sounds wrong, the spokesperson uses these pre-approved response frames. Do not improvise. Do not escalate rhetorically. Cite the text.

If the US Says...

Table NF-17 Response Frames — US Statements

US Statement	Iranian Response Frame
"Iran surrendered its HEU"	"Legal title remains with the Central Bank of Iran. Physical custody constitutes a verification step — not surrender. The US holds no veto over final disposition." (Art 1.1; Art 1.5)
"The PGSA is gone"	"The PGSA enjoys explicit recognition as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters (Article 4.2-B). The JHTA maintains advisory status only." (Art 4.2-B)
"Iran accepted unlimited inspections"	"IAEA access covers declared sites only, with continuous monitoring under agreed protocols. The Additional Protocol applies on a voluntary basis. No unlimited inspections exist." (Annex O; Art 3.2)
"Snapback is automatic"	"The Framework uses graduated stepback, not snapback. Every penalty is reversible through earnback. No benefit is permanently lost upon a single technical variance." (Annex T, Art II–III)

If Iran Says...

Table NF-18 Response Frames — Iranian Statements

Iranian Statement	US Response Frame
"The US lifted all sanctions"	"Nuclear-related sanctions are frozen conditionally. Non-nuclear terrorism and human rights sanctions remain fully enforceable. The framework reverses any relief upon breach." (Art 7; Annex T, Art II)
"We kept all our missiles"	"Offensive deployments and transfers are frozen. The pause is verifiable and real. Dismantlement was never required in Phase I." (Art 6.1–6.2)

"The US agreed to withdraw from the Gulf"	"Naval posture adjustments are reciprocal and reversible. Stand-off distances remain maintained. The US military presence in the region continues." (Art 6.3; Annex S, Week 3–4)
"Iran enriches freely after 12 years"	"The 12-year moratorium extends to 15 with verified compliance. Any post-moratorium enrichment falls under the safeguards and monitoring architecture established in Phase I. Nothing is automatic." (Art 2.1; Art 17.2)

Correction Note (v1.0)

In Table NF-17, the Iranian response frame for "Snapback is automatic" previously read: "Every penalty is reversible through **earthback**." This is corrected to "**earnback**" — the term used throughout Annex T (Adaptive Stabilization and Compliance Resilience Matrix).

Breach Response Frames (When the Other Side Violates)

If the Joint Secretariat or Shared Digital Registry issues a verified breach determination, the spokesperson uses the following frames — calibrated to acknowledge the violation without declaring the deal dead.

US Frame (if Iran breaches)

"The Shared Digital Registry confirms a violation of [specific provision]. Under Annex T, this triggers proportional stepback — not termination. The framework pauses affected benefits until Iran returns to compliance. The humanitarian firewall remains in place. The path to earnback stays open. Even a material breach fixed within a week faces only a 10% reduction — not 25%. The penalties are proportionate. We expect Iran to remedy this immediately."

(Annex T, Art II–III; Annex V, Art 4.4; Art 13)

Iranian Frame (if US breaches)

"The verification architecture documents a US violation of [specific provision]. Under the Accord's stepback mechanism, the framework pauses reciprocal benefits until the US corrects its action. This does not constitute a collapse — the system works as designed. A short-duration violation does not trigger full penalties. The system rewards quick remediation. We expect the US to return to compliance within the remediation window."

(Annex T, Art II–III; Annex V, Art 4.4; Art 13)

Neutral Frame (mediator / JIG)

"A violation of [specific provision] occurs. The Shared Digital Registry verifies it. The Accord's stepback provisions activate. The affected Party has [X] days to remediate. The humanitarian firewall remains in force. This tests the Accord's resilience architecture, not its failure."

(Annex T, Art II; Annex R.a, Art 5)

Key Principles for Breach Responses

- **The spokesperson never says the deal dies.** The stepback mechanism survives breaches.
- **The spokesperson always cites the specific provision violated.** General accusations escalate; specific citations discipline.
- **The spokesperson always affirms the humanitarian firewall.** Medicine and food continue regardless — the spokesperson says this every time.
- **The spokesperson always mentions earnback.** The path back to full compliance stays open; the spokesperson emphasizes this to avoid cornering the other side.
- **The spokesperson uses "stepback," not "snapback."** Snapback implies permanent reversal. Stepback implies temporary, proportional, reversible.

Attribution Blackout

When the JIG determines who caused an incident, a mandatory 72-hour media blackout activates. Neither side tries the case in public during this window. Senior officials who leak during the blackout face 5% benefit reductions.

US Frame

"The framework imposes a 72-hour media blackout during JIG attribution proceedings. Neither side prejudices the investigation through public statements. Leaks carry automatic penalties."

(Annex V, Art 4.7)

Iranian Frame

"The framework protects the attribution process from media contamination. A 72-hour blackout ensures facts establish themselves before narratives form. Officials who leak face proportional consequences."

(Annex V, Art 4.7)

Key Principles

- **The blackout is mandatory, not voluntary.** It activates automatically upon JIG incident classification.
- **Neither side speaks about attribution during the 72-hour window.** Early attribution claims violate the protocol.
- **Leaks carry consequences.** Senior officials who release information during the blackout trigger automatic 5% benefit reductions.
- **The sensors decide, not the press.** The JIG determines attribution based on verification data, not media narratives.

Mediator / Facilitator Neutral Frame

When Oman, Pakistan, Switzerland, or the JIG speaks publicly, the mediator uses the following neutral frame. It validates both sides without favoring either.

"The Accord provides reciprocal, verified steps. Neither side moves alone. Sensors, escrow confirmations, and physical locks measure compliance — not whose narrative speaks louder. Both capitals defend the sequencing as responding only when the other moves first or simultaneously."

Neutral Frame Principles for Mediators

- The mediator never characterizes an action as a "concession" or "surrender" by either side
- The mediator describes actions as "reciprocal," "verified," or "in accordance with the agreed schedule"
- The mediator points to the verification architecture, not to political intent: "The sensors tell us. We do not need to trust."
- When asked "who won?", the mediator responds: "The Accord provides mechanisms for both sides to demonstrate that their interests are protected. Both narratives are grounded in the operative text."
- The mediator never confirms or denies a claim made by either side's spokesperson. The mediator directs inquirers to the operative text.

Cross-reference: The Narrative Dispute Resolution process under **Annex T, Article IV.3** is available if either Party believes the other's framing has crossed into material misrepresentation. This constitutes a political process, not a legal one, and the Swiss mediator facilitates it with senior communications advisors (not lawyers).

Spokesperson Toolkit

If a spokesperson feels stuck — confronted with a question they did not anticipate, a claim they do not verify, or a frame that conflicts with the other side's statement — the spokesperson follows this three-step protocol:

Step 1: Cite the Article

Point to the text. *"That provision addresses itself in Article [X] of the Accord."* This buys time, demonstrates command of the document, and shifts the conversation from opinion to text.

Step 2: Use the Reciprocity Frame

"This stands in exchange for their verified commitment." Every benefit holds a corresponding obligation. Every obligation holds a corresponding benefit. The reciprocity frame reminds audiences that neither side gives anything away.

Step 3: Defer to the Verification Architecture

"The sensors tell us. We do not need to trust." This converts a political question into a technical one. The sensors remove the burden of trust and place it on verifiable data.

Bridge Phrases (When You Need 5 Seconds to Think)

The spokesperson uses these phrases to fill silence while locating the correct citation or frame:

Table NF-19 Approved Bridge Phrases

Phrase	When to Use
"That's an important question. Let me reference the text."	You know the answer but need to locate the specific article
"The Accord addresses that directly."	You are confident the answer exists in the document

"I understand the concern. Here is what the agreement actually says."	The question implies a false premise
"Let me be precise about what is and is not in the document."	The question conflates speculation with operative text
"I want to be careful not to characterize. Let me state the provision."	You need to avoid evaluative language
"Machines alert. Humans decide."	When asked about automated penalties or sensor-driven enforcement

Bridge Phrases — Do Not Use

Phrase	Why It Fails
"I don't know"	Projects uncertainty about your own document
"That's a good question"	Wasted words; adds no information; sounds evasive
"Let me check"	Implies you don't know your own document
"I get back to you"	Leaves the frame hanging; the reporter controls the narrative
"We need to consult"	Suggests you lack authority to speak

The Two-Question Rule (Repetitive Trap Protocol)

In press conferences, a reporter asks the same trap question three or four different ways, hoping the spokesperson slips. If a reporter asks the same question (or a transparent variant) a second time after receiving a complete answer:

First Repeat

The spokesperson repeats the original answer **verbatim** or with minimal rephrasing. **The spokesperson adds no new information.**

Second Repeat

State: *"I answered that question. I refer you to the text of the Accord, Article [X]. Next question."*

Third Repeat

State: *"You ask the same question again. I answered it twice. I now take a question from another reporter."*

Why This Matters

Repetitive questioning creates a "gotcha" moment by exhaustion. This protocol shuts it down **without appearing evasive**. The spokesperson appears disciplined, not defensive — and the reporter appears obsessive, not insightful.

Anchor Lines (Repeat Every Press Conference)

These lines appear in every major statement — not as a script, but as a recurring theme. They are the narrative equivalent of a watermark.

Table NF-20 Anchor Lines by Side

US Anchor Line	Iranian Anchor Line
"Iran performs. The US responds. That constitutes reciprocity."	"The US lifts pressure. We keep our sovereignty. That constitutes reciprocity."
"This deal runs on sensors, not trust."	"Verification constitutes a tool, not a surrender."
"No front-loading enters this deal. No free lunches exist."	"The framework gives nothing away. Everything earns its place."
"Stepback is temporary. Snapback does not exist in this agreement."	"Penalties are proportional. Nothing is permanent unless we fail to perform."

Usage Guidance

Anchor lines are not openers or closers. They are **recurring beats** — dropped after a key point, used to transition between topics, or repeated when a question challenges the fundamental architecture. A spokesperson who uses the same anchor line three times in a single press conference is doing it right. Consistency creates recognition. Recognition creates credibility.

Press Conference Checklist

Before every press conference or public statement, the spokesperson confirms:

- Every claim in the prepared remarks traces to a specific article or annex
- No prohibited phrases appear in the text
- No red-line statements are present or implied
- At least one of the Three Permanent Frames (Verification, Reciprocity, Duration) is present
- At least one Anchor Line is embedded in the remarks
- Response frames for likely provocative questions are pre-loaded
- Breach response frames are available if a verified violation has occurred
- The mediator neutral frame is available if asked to comment on the other side's statement
- Bridge phrases are memorized for unexpected questions
- The Two-Question Rule is understood and ready to deploy
- The Synchronisation Sentence has been reviewed and cleared by both sides' communications teams

Social Media Guidance

Social media posts by official accounts carry the same framing obligations as press conferences. In addition:

- Tweets and posts include the citation hashtag (e.g., #Art11 #AnnexO) to reinforce traceability
- Graphics showing the sequencing schedule (Annex S) prove highly effective for demonstrating reciprocity
- Video of IAEA inspectors at work supports the Verification frame
- Infographics of the escrow mechanism support the Reciprocity frame
- The spokesperson never responds to trolling or provocative posts from unofficial accounts — engagement validates the provocation
- Anchor lines make excellent pinned posts and profile headers

Handling Leaks (Unofficial Documents)

Leaks happen. A draft of an annex, a negotiating position, an internal disagreement — all of it finds its way to a reporter. The following protocol applies to all leak scenarios.

If a Reporter Asks About a Leaked Document

Standard response:

"I have not seen that document. The only authoritative text exists in the signed Accord and its incorporated annexes. I do not comment on unofficial papers."

If a Reporter Asks About a Leaked Internal Disagreement

Example: *"Is it true that your negotiator threatened to walk?"*

Standard response:

"I do not comment on internal deliberations. The signed Accord constitutes the only outcome that matters."

Leak Response Protocol

Table NF-21 Leak Response Do's and Don'ts

Do	Do Not
Redirect to the signed text. Every. Single. Time.	Confirm the document's authenticity
State clearly: "The signed Accord stands as the only authoritative text"	Deny it outright (if it might later be confirmed)
If pressed: "I do not comment on unofficial papers"	Engage with hypotheticals based on the leak
Maintain the same frame regardless of leak content	Adjust your narrative in response to leaked information
Report the leak to the Joint Secretariat after the press conference	Speculate about the source or motive of the leak

Why This Protocol Works

Every leak response strategy other than "redirect to the signed text" creates risk:

- **Confirming authenticity** validates the leak as relevant and gives it official status
- **Denying outright** sets up a "gotcha" moment if the leak is later confirmed by another source
- **Engaging with hypotheticals** allows the reporter to construct a narrative using your voice
- **Redirecting to the signed text** denies the leak oxygen without lying, stonewalling, or acknowledging it

Internal Escalation

After any press conference involving leak questions, the spokesperson notifies the Joint Secretariat and the relevant press office. The Joint Secretariat maintains a leak log to identify patterns and potential sources.

Closing Lines & Anchor Lines

A memorable final line works in almost any press conference:

Table NF-22 Closing Lines by Side

US Closing Line	Iranian Closing Line
"This deal doesn't run on trust. It runs on sensors."	"Our sovereignty is preserved. Our rights are intact. Our future is in our own hands."

When to Use the Closing Line

- At the end of every prepared statement
- As a response to "What's your bottom line?" or "What's the one thing you want people to remember?"
- After a hostile exchange, to reassert control of the narrative
- As the final tweet in a thread, or the pinned post on social media

Additional Pre-Approved Quotes by Side

US Additional Quotes

Context	Quote	Citation
On verification	"Trust constitutes a luxury. Verification constitutes a necessity. The IAEA stands on the ground. The sensors transmit. That constitutes what matters."	Art 1.1; Annex O
On reciprocity	"We do not open the escrow because we feel generous. We open it because Iran meets the milestone. Performance comes first. Benefits follow."	Annex S; Art 8.2
On duration	"No expiration date exists for compliance. The deal continues as long as both sides keep their commitments."	Art 17.2–17.4
On the buffer	"A single incident does not collapse months of diplomacy. The 72-hour buffer exists precisely so that cooler heads prevail."	Annex R; Annex R.a

On maritime security	"Freedom of navigation is not negotiable. The JHTA ensures safe transit for commercial vessels without tolls."	Art 4; Art 5; Annex N.a
On the NAC	"Iran appoints a single official with binding authority over IRGC access. That constitutes accountability. That constitutes what responsible states do."	Annex Q, Art 3
On Phase II	"Phase I proves the concept. Phase II deepens the constraints. But nothing in Phase II enters automatically — every provision requires negotiation."	Art 17; Preamble

Iranian Additional Quotes

Context	Quote	Citation
On sovereignty	"No foreign soldier sets foot in our nuclear facilities. No foreign power holds title to our material. Our sovereignty is not negotiable."	Art 1.1; Art 1.3; Art 1.6
On reciprocity	"The US froze sanctions because we fulfilled our obligations. We earned every concession through performance, not pleading."	Annex S; Art 7
On enrichment rights	"The NPT guarantees our right to peaceful nuclear energy. This Accord does not surrender that right — it manages it, step by step, with verification."	Art 2.1; Preamble
On the buffer	"A single drone does not become a pretext for war. The buffer insures us against escalation by miscalculation."	Annex R; Annex R.a, Art 1
On maritime rights	"The PGSA constitutes the sole authority in our territorial waters. The JHTA coordinates internationally — but it does not command Iranian waters."	Art 4.2-B; Art 4.3
On the IRGC	"The IRGC defends our nation. The NAC ensures that defense does not obstruct verification. Both express Iranian sovereignty."	Annex Q, Art 2–3
On Phase II	"Phase I constitutes a foundation, not a cage. Phase II constitutes a new negotiation, with our full rights on the table. We enter it from a position of strength."	Art 17; Preamble

Closing Note

This guide does not constitute a script. It constitutes a permission structure for each side to emphasize what it needs without lying and without forcing the other side to contradict.

The architecture of the Narrative Framing Guide mirrors the architecture of the Accord itself: modular, reciprocal, and verified. Each frame constitutes a module. Each module holds a counterpart. Neither module invalidates the other.

The document wins. The narratives coexist. The deal survives.

When both sides read from the same document at the same moment, pointing to different paragraphs, the world sees coordination rather than capitulation. The Accord survives its first public test — and every public test thereafter — because both sides defend it honestly.

Version Control

This constitutes **Version 1.2** of the Narrative Framing Guide. The Joint Secretariat issues updates when new annexes enter the framework, new issue areas arise, or new key moments require pre-approved talking points. All updates maintain the Core Principle: the same text allows both sides to claim victory.

Summary of v1.0 Additions

- **Annex M Talking Points:** Pre-approved responses to territorial freeze questions
- **Non-Negotiable Narrative Red Lines:** Statements each side never agrees with
- **Two-Question Rule:** Protocol for handling repetitive trap questions
- **Bridge Phrases:** Approved language for buying thinking time
- **Breach Response Frames:** Calibrated responses for verified violations
- **Anchor Lines:** Recurring watermark lines for every press conference
- **Handling Leaks:** Protocol for responding to unofficial document disclosures
- **Closing Lines:** Final statements for any press conference
- **Additional Quotes:** Expanded library of pre-approved quotes by context
- **Typo Correction:** Table NF-17 — "earthback" corrected to "earnback"

Summary of v1.1 Additions

- **Guide Enforcement Clause:** Added to Verification Discipline — voluntary status with Joint Secretariat logging of persistent violations and potential Annex T, Article IV.3

review

Summary of v1.2 Additions

- **Synchronisation Sentence section:** Three template sentences for Iranian public framing of enhanced verification (Technical, Reciprocity, Strategic Choice emphasis)
- **No clawback frame (updated):** Revised with Annex V v2.0 Art 4.5 citation — "A clean break, not a trap" / "A clean exit path"
- **CANDOR / Nuclear Dust row:** Added to Table NF-2 (HEU Custody) for 99.7% extraction framing
- **Dual-key sovereignty row:** Added to Table NF-2 for digital key architecture framing
- **Entombment fallback row:** Added to Table NF-2 for monitored in-place containment
- **Stepback anchor line** : Added to Table NF-20
- **Tier 2 / 7-day proportional penalty:** Added to Breach Response Frames
- **Attribution Blackout section:** 72-hour media blackout with leak penalties
- **Review Pause (Political Shock Absorber):** Added to Table NF-10 for election/transition survival
- **Phase II talking points (updated):** Added explicit "new negotiation" and "nothing enters unless we agree" frames
- **Human-in-the-loop bridge phrase:** "Machines alert. Humans decide." added to Table NF-19
- **Russian escrow guarantor row:** Added to Table NF-5
- **Tier 3 interest freeze note:** Added to Table NF-5 with explanatory box
- **Transparency note:** Added "What this guide does not contain" to Closing Note

What This Guide Does Not Contain

This guide does not contain the precise sentence Iran uses to confirm its acceptance of enhanced verification. Iran speaks that sentence in its own voice. This guide only defines the category of acceptable phrasing — and demonstrates that the architecture supports it.

This guide does not contain classified operational details. It contains only narrative frames — choices of emphasis, not secret provisions.

This guide does not guarantee success. It guarantees that both sides speak from the same document without contradicting each other.

Authentication

This document comes from the Joint Secretariat, Muscat, Sultanate of Oman, in coordination with the Office of the Spokesperson, US Department of State, and the Office of the Spokesperson, Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

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Joint Secretariat, Muscat

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Cleared by:

US State Department — Office of the
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Date: _____

Cleared by:

Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — Office of the Spokesperson

Date: _____

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